Chi Danh Dao (Dan)

Contact Information

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Personal Information: Canadian–Vietnamese Dual Citizen

Education

- **Queen's University, Canada**
  Ph.D. Candidate in Economics , 2021–Present, GPA: 4.1
- **University of New Brunswick, Canada**
  M.A. in Economics, 2019–2021, GPA: 4.3
- **Tan Tao University, Vietnam**
  B.Sc. in Finance and Accounting, Cum Laude, 2011–2015

Affiliation

- **Bank Of Canada, Canada**
  External academic consultant, 2026–

Research Projects

- *Rewards, Credit Access, and Inequality in the Credit Card Market* (**Job Market Paper**)

  Abstract: This paper examines the distributional consequences of credit cards by quantifying how unevenly welfare gains from these products are distributed across consumers. Whereas existing literature models credit cards as either payment methods or sources of liquidity; I model demand for both functions and quantify their value to consumers. I first show that cardholders who borrow from their credit cards (i.e., Revolvers), do so to fund their consumption. Because nominal reward-based metrics (i.e., rewards minus fees) omit this consumption utility, they understate the benefits of credit cards to these consumers. This omission is consequential: accounting for both functions reveals that credit cards generate CAD 9.1 billion in annual welfare gains to consumers, far exceeding the CAD 0.825 billion implied by reward-based metrics. Because revolving cardholders often receive negative net monetary transfers and earn lower incomes than their non-revolving counterparts, reward-based metrics also overstate the Gini coefficient of welfare gains by 44%. Finally, eliminating the credit function increases the Gini coefficient of card-derived welfare gains by 7%. This result indicates that access to revolving credit can be progressive and challenges the view of credit card borrowing as inherently exploitative.

- *Profiles of Debt: Revolving Behavior and Financial Well-Being*

  Abstract: This paper examines the financial well-being and consumption dynamics of credit card users who carry revolving balances (i.e., Revolvers). Using microdata from the Bank of Canada's, I find limited evidence that Revolvers lack sufficient savings to absorb unexpected

shocks and maintain adequate consumption during retirement. Despite earning less and appearing to face tighter liquidity constraints, Revolvers report financial assets, liabilities, and financial comfort similar to non-revolving consumers (i.e., Convenience users). Available evidence also undermines concerns that revolving cardholders experience sharp declines in consumption during retirement.

Publication

- **Brodeur, Abel, et al.** (2026). "Reproducibility and Robustness of Economics and Political Science Research." *Nature*, 652, 151–156. doi:10.1038/s41586-026-10251-x.
  - Member of the replication team.
- **Dao, C. D.** (2026). Perceptions versus realities in the credit card market: Consumer vulnerability, competition, and inequality (JDI Policy Insight Series No. 2026-0702). John Deutsch Institute, Queen's University. https://hdl.handle.net/1974/36540

Teaching Experience

- Head teaching assistant ECON 212 - Microeconomics Theory II, Queen's University, Fall 2025-Fall 2026.
- Teaching assistant, ECON 852 - Quantitative Methods , Queen's University, Winter 2024.

Work Experience

- PhD Internship, Currency Department, Bank of Canada, 2024
- Data Scientist, Tiki, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
- Data Scientist, Homecredit Vietnam, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

Presentations

- Canadian Economics Association Conference, 2021, 2024
- Bank of Canada, 2024

Awards, Honors and Scholarships

- John Deutsch Institute for the Study of Economic Policy Student Fellowship, 2026
- Harold Burke Memorial Scholarship, 2020
- Faculty of Arts Graduate Assistantship (AGA), University of New Brunswick, 2019–2021
- Full Scholarship, Tan Tao University, 2011–2015

Technical Skills: Python, R, GAMS, Matlab, C

Personal Information

Languages: English, Vietnamese

References

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